Political Divisions



The continent of Africa consists of 54 countries. On the basis of their geographical location, the countries are grouped as a) West Africa b) North Africa c) Central Africa d) Eastern Africa e) Southern Africa.



The north-western African countries of Morocco, Algeria, Libya, Mauritania and Tunisia are collectively called '**Maghreb**' which means west in Arabic language.

Physiographic Divisions

Africa consists of mixture of land forms such as mountains, plateaus and plains. The following are the 8 major physical divisions of Africa. Madagaskar is the major island of Africa.

1. Sahara

The world-famous Sahara Desert is located in the northern part of Africa. It is one of the largest hot deserts in the world. It has an area of 9.2 million sq km. The Sahara is bordered by the Atlantic Ocean in the west, the Red Sea in the east, the Mediterranean Sea in the north and Sahel in the south. This desert covers the areas of 11 countries: Algeria, Chad, Egypt, Libya, Mali, Mauritania, Morocco, Niger, Western Sahara, Sudan and Tunisia.

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